MNDAA, while the EAGs' conference in Pang Sang was in progress. The letter from the Tatmadaw to the Myanmar Press Council (Interim) stated that, "if the media broadcast or publish statements of the MNDAA, they will face action under the law" (Ye Mon and Lun Min Mang 2015). This suggests that the peace technical team's facilitation of ethnic summits did not diminish the Tatmadaw's exercise of power on the EAGs, making it willing to continue to adhere to the peace process.

## CONCLUSION

In this chapter I have explained how the Thein Sein government was able to sustain the peace process in Myanmar despite many constraints. Throughout the chapter, I have focused on the institutional role of the peace technical team, the MPC, and its strategy for sustaining the ongoing peace process. A fairly detailed examination followed of how the peace process obtained continuing participation from the Tatmadaw and EAGs although there have been several altercations between them. One way to analyse the work of the peace technical team is through case studies, throwing light on their coping strategies in terms of policy vision and practice, to arrive at several key observations and conclusions.

My findings offer two major contributions to the understanding of the peace policymaking process in Myanmar. First, the role of the MPC has been more than that of a formal secretariat. The emergence of the MPC under the transitional government changed the nature of the peace policy process. Although the UPWC officially kept the highest policy implementation under its authority, the directions to be pursued in the peace process from 2012 to 2015 came almost entirely under the purview of the MPC and non-ministerial affairs. Individuals in the government's peace team who were completely in charge of policy formulation under Team A found their influence diminishing with time. As Team A kept losing its power, the MPC secured better control over the peace process in terms of agenda setting and implementation.

Membership of the core group is critical in any policy community focusing on interactions with other policy actors through personal attributes. Limited numbers of participants make the MPC a resourceful centre of the "policy community". Local media often raised attention to the discriminatory nature of peace operations whenever the MPC acted